

FileBank WorkFlow

User Manual

Step-by-step instructions for people who submit requests and people who approve them

Each task in this manual is a short list of steps with a picture of the screen; the button or box a step talks about is outlined in red. Look up what you want to do in the contents and follow the steps. The pictures show a demonstration organisation, Riverside Academy, with made-up people such as Sam Submitter and Maria Manager - your organisation's name, logo, forms and people will be your own. Administrators have a separate manual.

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CHAPTER 1

How it works

FileBank WorkFlow moves a request through a series of approval steps. Each form has its own chain of approvers, set up by your administrator.

1. A **submitter** fills in a form and submits it. The request gets a number such as **REQ-000123**.
2. The approver of **step 1** is emailed. They open the request and choose **Approve**, **Send back for changes** or **Reject**.
3. Each approval moves the request to the next step, until the last one. Then it is **Approved**: a PDF of the whole record is made and the submitter is emailed.
4. **Send back** returns the request to the submitter to fix; when they resubmit, it goes straight back to the same step. **Reject** ends the request for good.

Your role	What you can do
Submitter	Submit forms, follow your own requests, make changes when one is sent back, download the PDF.
Approver	Decide on the steps sent to you: approve (with your signature), send back or reject.
Administrator	Set up forms, people and settings (see the Administrator Manual).

One person can have several roles; the home page then shows a section for each. Under **Help** (top right) you can also open **How a request works (workflow)**: the whole process on two pages.

CHAPTER 2

Getting started

Sign in for the first time

You need: the address of your organisation's site (for example <https://acme.vwf.filebankinc.com>) and access to your work email.

- 1 Open your organisation's address. Type your **work email** and choose **Continue**.

The screenshot shows the Riverside Academy sign-in interface. On the left, a dark sidebar contains the text 'Riverside Academy' at the top, followed by 'Requests and approvals' in large white text, and a smaller paragraph: 'Submit a form, follow it through each approval step, and keep the signed PDF of every decision.' At the bottom of the sidebar, it says 'Your 6-digit password key is yours alone. Nobody from support will ever ask for it.' The main area is light gray and titled 'Sign in'. It features a 'Work email' label above a text input field. Below the input field is a yellow 'Continue' button. A note below the button states: 'First time here? Enter your email and you will be asked to create your 6-digit password key.'

- 2 A **6-digit code** is emailed to you (valid for 10 minutes). Type the code, your **full name**, and a **6-digit password key** of your own choice twice, then choose **Create key and sign in**.

The screenshot shows the Riverside Academy password key creation interface. The sidebar is identical to the previous screen. The main area is titled 'Create your password key'. It shows the email 'new.teacher@riverside.test' with a 'change' link. Below is a 'Verification code' label and a text input field. A note says: 'We emailed a 6-digit code to new.teacher@riverside.test. It expires in 10 minutes.' Next is the 'Your full name' label and a text input field. Then, the 'Choose a 6-digit password key' label and a text input field, with a note: 'Digits only. Avoid obvious keys such as 123456 or 111111 - they are refused.' This is followed by the 'Repeat the key' label and another text input field. A yellow 'Create key and sign in' button is at the bottom. A final note says: 'No email? Check junk mail, or go back and continue again after a minute to get a new code.'

RESULT

You are signed in and see your home page. From now on you sign in with your email and your key.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- No email? Look in your junk folder. Choose **change**, enter your email again and **Continue** for a new code (after a minute).
- The key must be exactly six digits; obvious keys such as 123456 or 111111 are refused.
- "Only your organisation's email addresses can be used here": use your work address.

Sign in

- 1 Open your organisation's address, type your work email and choose **Continue**.
- 2 Type your **6-digit password key** and choose **Sign in**.

RESULT

Your home page opens. You stay signed in when you reload the page; choose **Sign out** (top right) on a shared computer.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- After **5 wrong keys** the account is locked for 15 minutes - wait, or use **Forgot your key?** below the key box.
- Forgotten your key: choose **Forgot your key?**, enter the emailed code and choose a new key.

Find your way around

- 1 Your **home page** shows what you can do: **Start a new request** (the forms you can fill in), **My submissions** (your requests) and, for approvers, **Waiting for my approval**.

Riverside Academy Help · Sam Submitter Sign out

Start a new request

Purchase Request
Request approval to buy goods or services.

My submissions All Needs my changes In progress Approved Rejected

REQ-000003 · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● Sent back
 Sent back to you by Maria Manager: Please add the supplier's quote number to the justification. [Make the changes](#)

REQ-000006 · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● In progress
 Step 2 of 3 (Finance), waiting on **Frank Finance** for less than an hour

REQ-000005 · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● In progress
 Step 1 of 3 (Line manager), waiting on **Maria Manager** for less than an hour

REQ-000004 · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● In progress
 Step 1 of 3 (Line manager), waiting on **Maria Manager** for less than an hour

REQ-000002 · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● Rejected
 Rejected at step 2 (Finance): Not in this year's training budget. Please apply again in the spring. [Archived PDF](#)

- 2 Top right: **Help** opens the manuals and the workflow sheet; the small screen icon switches **light / dark** colours; **your name** opens your account (password key and approval emails).

Help · Sam Submitter Sign out

User Manual

How a request works (workflow)

Change your password key

- 1 Click **your name** at the top right.
- 2 Under **Change password key** type your current key and the new key twice, then choose **Change key**.

RESULT

Your new key works at once; your other devices are signed out.

CHAPTER 3

Submitting requests

Submit a request

You need: the Submitter role.

- 1 On your home page, under **Start a new request**, click the form you need (see the picture under "Find your way around").
- 2 Fill in the fields. Fields marked with a red * are required. Some forms ask you to choose **who approves it first** in a **Send to** box at the bottom.

The screenshot shows a web form for Riverside Academy. The header includes the logo, name, and navigation links. The form contains several required fields marked with an asterisk. The 'Estimated cost' field is highlighted with a yellow border. At the bottom, there is a 'Send to' section with a dropdown menu.

Riverside Academy Help · Sam Submitter Sign out

What do you need? *

Whiteboard markers

Business justification *

Two boxes for the maths department.

Estimated cost *

45.80

Category *

Other

Needed by

mm/dd/yyyy

☐ Urgent

Send to - step 1: Line manager

Approver

- 3 Choose **Submit for approval**.

RESULT

The request page opens with a green confirmation, and the first approver is emailed. You receive a "We received your request" email.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- If something is missing or wrong, nothing is submitted: the fields are highlighted with a message. Correct them and submit again.
- Sent something by mistake? Ask an administrator to cancel it - you cannot withdraw it yourself.

Follow your requests

- 1 Your home page lists **My submissions**, newest first, with anything sent back to you at the top. The coloured bars show each step: **green** approved, **amber** waiting now, **purple** sent back to you, **red** rejected, **grey** not reached yet. The buttons at the top filter the list.

My submissions

Filters: All | Needs my changes | In progress | Approved | Rejected

- REQ-000003** · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● Sent back
 Sent back to you by Maria Manager: Please add the supplier's quote number to the justification. [Make the changes](#)
- REQ-000006** · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● In progress
 Step 2 of 3 (Finance), waiting on **Frank Finance** for less than an hour
- REQ-000005** · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● In progress
 Step 1 of 3 (Line manager), waiting on **Maria Manager** for less than an hour
- REQ-000004** · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● In progress
 Step 1 of 3 (Line manager), waiting on **Maria Manager** for less than an hour
- REQ-000002** · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● Rejected ● Archived PDF
 Rejected at step 2 (Finance): Not in this year's training budget. Please apply again in the spring.
- REQ-000001** · Purchase Request · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM ● Approved ● Final PDF
 All 3 steps approved · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM

- 2 Click a request number to open it. **Progress** shows every step: who decided and when, or who has it now and for how long.

Progress

- ✓ **Submitted**
Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM
- ✓ **Line manager** ● Approved
Maria Manager · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM
- 2 **Finance** ● Active
Waiting on **Frank Finance** since Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM (less than an hour)
- 3 **Director** ○ Waiting
Dana Director

Make changes when a request is sent back

You need: a request an approver sent back to you (you receive a "Changes needed" email).

- 1 Open the request (from the email, or **Needs my changes** on your home page). The purple box says who sent it back and what to change. Choose **Make the changes**.

Maria Manager sent this back to you for changes on Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM (step 1, Line manager):

Please add the supplier's quote number to the justification.

Steps already approved stay approved. When you resubmit, it goes straight back to Maria Manager.

Make the changes

- 2 The form opens with your answers filled in. Change what was asked. A drawn signature is not carried over: sign again. Optionally add a **note** for the approver. Choose **Resubmit to**

Riverside Academy Help · Sam Submitter Sign out

Purchase Request · REQ-000003 [Sent back](#)

Make changes and resubmit

Maria Manager asked for these changes on Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM:

Please add the supplier's quote number to the justification.

What do you need? *

Ergonomic desk chair

Business justification *

For the front office - the current chair is broken.

Estimated cost *

420.00

Category *

Hardware

Needed by

RESULT

The request goes straight back to the approver who sent it back; they are emailed a list of exactly what you changed. Earlier approvals stay approved.

When a request is rejected

- 1 You receive an email with the **reason**; the request page shows it in a red box with the step, the approver and the date.

Rejected at step 2 (Finance) by Frank Finance on Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM

Reason: Not in this year's training budget. Please apply again in the spring.

This decision is final and the request cannot be reopened. To pursue it again, [start a new request using these details](#).

- 2 Rejection is **final**. To try again, choose **start a new request using these details**: a new form opens with your answers filled in.

Download the PDF

You need: a finished (approved or rejected) request.

- 1 Open the request and choose **Download final PDF** (or **Archived PDF** for a rejected one). The list on your home page has the same link.

The screenshot shows the 'Riverside Academy' header with navigation links: Help, Sam Submitter, and Sign out. The main content area is titled 'Purchase Request' and 'REQ-000001', with a status of 'Approved' and a timestamp 'Submitted Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM · closed Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM'. A green message box states 'Fully approved. All 3 approval steps are complete.' Below this is a yellow button labeled 'Download final PDF'. A 'Progress' section lists four steps, each with a green checkmark and an 'Approved' status: Submitted (Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM), Line manager (Maria Manager · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM), Finance (Frank Finance · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM), and Director (Dana Director · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM). At the bottom, there is a 'Your submission' section with a 'Read-only' label.

RESULT

The PDF has your submission, every decision with the approver's signature, and a summary of what happened. Its name is the form name, the request number and the date it was submitted, for example **Purchase-R_000123_01102026.pdf**.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

"The PDF is being prepared": it is made within a minute of the decision. Refresh the page.

Emails you will receive

Email	When
We received your ... request	Right after you submit.
Changes needed: your ... request	An approver sent it back; it says what to change and has a Make the changes button.
Your ... request is fully approved	The last approver approved it.
Your ... request was rejected	Any approver rejected it, with the reason.
Your ... request was cancelled	An administrator cancelled it, with their reason.

CHAPTER 4

Approving requests

Open a request from the approval email

You need: the Approver role.

- 1 When a request reaches your step you receive **Approval needed: ...** with the request's details and three buttons: **Approve**, **Send back for changes** and **Reject**. Choose one, or **Open the full request**.

Approval needed: Purchase Request REQ-000004

Hello Maria Manager,

A request is waiting for your decision at step "Line manager".

Form: Purchase Request

Request: REQ-000004

Submitted by: Sam Submitter

Request details

What do you need?	Projector for room 12
Business justification	The old projector no longer turns on; lessons in room 12 rely on it.
Estimated cost	689.00
Category	Hardware
Urgent	Yes

Approve
Send back for changes
Reject

[Open the full request](#)

You will be asked to sign in, and to sign on screen to approve. Nothing is decided until you confirm on that page. This link is personal to you and expires in 14 days.

This is an automated message from FileBank WorkFlow. Please do not reply.

- 2 Sign in if asked. The request opens ready for the choice you made; nothing is decided until you confirm on the page.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- The link is **personal**: it only works for your account. Forwarding it does not let a colleague act - ask an administrator to reassign the step or add a delegate.
- "This link can't be used": it expired (after 14 days) or was replaced by a newer email. Use **Waiting for my approval** on your home page instead.

Find what is waiting for you

- 1 Your home page lists **Waiting for my approval**, oldest first, with how long each has waited; **Overdue** marks one past its reminder time. Click a request number to open it.

Waiting for my approval					Approve selected
☐	Request	Form	Submitted by	Step	Waiting since
☐	REQ-000004	Purchase Request	Sam Submitter	1 of 3: Line manager	Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM (less than an hour)
☐	REQ-000005	Purchase Request	Sam Submitter	1 of 3: Line manager	Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM (less than an hour)

Review a request

- 1 The approval page shows the **original submission** (read-only) at the top. Read it before you decide.

Riverside Academy
Help · Maria Manager Sign out

Purchase Request · REQ-000004
In progress

Step 1 of 3: Line manager

Submitted by Sam Submitter on Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM

Original submission
Read-only

What do you need? Projector for room 12	Business justification The old projector no longer turns on; lessons in room 12 rely on it.	Estimated cost 689.00	Category Hardware
Needed by —	Urgent Yes		

Your section

Approve Send back for changes Reject

Comments

Attach documents

Choose Files No file chosen

- 2 From step 2 on, **Previous approvals** shows each earlier step: who decided, when, their comments, their signature and any documents they attached. You never see later steps.

Previous approvals Read-only

Step 1: Line manager ● Approved

Maria Manager · Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM

No fields.

Same as last year.

Approve a request

- 1 In **Your section**, keep **Approve** selected.
- 2 Add **Comments** if you wish, and attach supporting documents under **Attach documents** (optional; PDF, Office files, text or images, up to 10 MB each - only approvers and administrators can see them).
- 3 **Sign** in the **Your signature** box with your finger, a stylus or the mouse (**Undo** removes the last stroke, **Clear** starts again). If a **Send to** box shows a list, choose who approves the next step. Then choose **Approve** (or **Approve and send on**).

Your section

Approve Send back for changes Reject

Comments

Urgent - approved.

Attach documents

Choose Files No file chosen

Optional. PDF, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, text or images, up to 10 MB each (0 of 10). Only approvers and administrators can see them.

Your signature *

Undo Clear

Needed to approve. Sending back or rejecting does not need a signature.

Send to - step 2 of 3: Finance

Approver

Frank Finance

They will be emailed a link as soon as you approve.

Approve and send on

RESULT

A green message says the request moved to the next step - whose approver is emailed - or, on the last step, that it is fully approved. Your section is now read-only.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- "Sign to approve": draw your signature first.
- "This step has already been completed": you (in another tab) or a delegate decided it already. Refresh the page.

Send a request back for changes

- 1 In **Your section** choose **Send back for changes**, type in **What needs to change?** what the submitter should do (required - they see it word for word), then choose **Send back to** No signature is needed.

The screenshot shows a web interface titled "Your section". At the top, there are three buttons: "Approve", "Send back for changes" (which is highlighted in yellow), and "Reject". Below these buttons is a large text input area with a purple border. The label "What needs to change? *" is at the top left of this area. Inside the text box, the text "Please say which room the old projector can be collected from." is entered. Below the text box, a small note reads: "Sam Submitter is emailed this and can edit the request and resubmit it. It comes straight back to you." At the bottom of the purple-bordered area is a yellow button with a red border labeled "Send back to Sam Submitter".

RESULT

The request leaves your list. When the submitter resubmits, it comes back to you with a "Resubmitted for approval" email and a purple box listing exactly what they changed. Earlier approvals stay.

Reject a request

- 1 In **Your section** choose **Reject**, type the **reason for rejection** (required - it is sent to the submitter word for word) and choose **Confirm rejection**. No signature is needed.

Your section

Approve

Send back for changes

Reject

Reason for rejection *

We are replacing all projectors next year.

Rejection is final: the workflow stops, the submitter is sent this reason, and the request cannot be reopened. If it only needs fixing, send it back instead.

Confirm rejection

RESULT

The request stops for good, the submitter and the administrators are emailed, and a PDF marked REJECTED is kept. If the request only needs fixing, send it back instead.

Approve several requests at once

You need: two or more requests waiting for you.

- 1 Under **Waiting for my approval**, tick the requests (or **Select all**) and choose **Approve selected**.

Waiting for my approval

Approve selected (2)

☒	Request	Form	Submitted by	Step	Waiting since
☒	REQ-000004	Purchase Request	Sam Submitter	1 of 3 · Line manager	Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM (less than an hour)
☒	REQ-000005	Purchase Request	Sam Submitter	1 of 3 · Line manager	Oct 1, 2026, 2:50 PM (less than an hour)

2

Check each request's details in the panel; **Remove** takes one out. If a **Send to** box appears under a request, choose who approves next (**Send the other ... too** copies your choice). Optionally add a **Comment for all of them** or **Add a comment for this request**. **Sign** once and choose **Approve N requests**.

Approve 2 requests

Check each one. Anything that needs a closer look: open it instead, and untick it here.

[REQ-000004](#) · Purchase Request · from Sam Submitter · step 1 of 3 [Remove](#)

What do you need? Projector for room 12 · Business justification: The old projector no longer turns on; lessons in room 12 rely on it. · Estimated cost: 689.00 · Category: Hardware

[Add a comment for this request](#)

[REQ-000005](#) · Purchase Request · from Sam Submitter · step 1 of 3 [Remove](#)

What do you need? Science lab supplies · Business justification: Beakers, safety goggles and test tubes for the autumn term. · Estimated cost: 312.50 · Category: Other

[Add a comment for this request](#)

Comment for all of them

Optional. Saved on every request above; a request's own comment is added after it.

Your signature *



Undo Clear

One signature for all of them; it is saved with each approval and printed in each PDF.

Approve 2 requests

Back

RESULT

A list shows each request: approved and moved on, fully approved, or not approved with the reason (the others are not affected). Your signature is saved with each one.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Only approving works in a batch. To send back or reject, open the request. At most 50 at a time.

Get one summary email a day instead

1

Click **your name** at the top right.

- 2 Under **Approval emails** choose **Send me one summary a day instead**, then pick the hour in **Send it at** (your own time zone is shown under it).

Approval emails

Done. You get one summary each weekday at 7:00 AM, and no email per request.

☐ **Email me about each request as it arrives**

☒ **Send me one summary a day instead** - Monday to Friday, listing everything waiting for you, only when something is

Send it at

7:00 AM

Your time (America/New York). It arrives within a few minutes after.

Either way, everything waiting is always on your home page. With the summary you get no separate approval, resubmitted or reminder emails; an administrator's own reminder still reaches you straight away.

RESULT

Monday to Friday at that hour you get one email listing everything waiting for you - only when something is - instead of an email per request. Choose **Email me about each request as it arrives** to switch back. An administrator's own reminder still reaches you straight away.

Reminders, reassignment and delegates

- If the form has reminder rules, you receive **Reminder: approval needed** after the set number of days (not with the daily summary - it reminds you every weekday).
- An administrator can **reassign** your step to someone else, or add a **delegate** who can act as well as you. Whoever decides first is recorded.
- Going on leave? Ask an administrator to add a delegate or reassign your open steps.

CHAPTER 5

Reference and troubleshooting

Request statuses

Status	Meaning
In progress	Waiting for the approver of the current step - or, marked Sent back , waiting for the submitter's changes.
Approved	Every step approved. Final. PDF available.
Rejected	Rejected at one step. Final. Reason shown; PDF available.
Cancelled	Stopped by an administrator before completion. Final.

Step statuses

Status	Meaning
Waiting	Earlier steps are not finished yet.
Active	Waiting for this approver now.
Sent back	This approver sent the request back for changes. It becomes Active again when the submitter resubmits.
Approved / Rejected	Decided. The section is locked.
Not reached	An earlier step rejected the request, so this step never started.
Cancelled	The request was cancelled before this step was decided.

Common messages

Message	What to do
Incorrect email or password key	Check your email address and key. After 5 wrong attempts the account locks for 15 minutes. Forgotten the key? Use Forgot your key? on the sign-in page.
That code is not right / This code has expired	Use the code from the latest email. After 5 wrong attempts or 10 minutes, go back and continue again for a new code.
This account already has a password key	You are already set up: sign in with your key, or use Forgot your key?

Message	What to do
This link can't be used	The approval link expired, was replaced by a newer one, the step was reassigned, or you are signed in as someone else. Check Waiting for my approval , or ask an administrator for a reminder.
This approval does not exist or is not assigned to you	The step belongs to someone else. Make sure you are signed in with the right account.
Sign to approve	Draw your signature in the Your signature box, then choose Approve again.
Say what needs to change	Sending back needs a message for the submitter. Type it in What needs to change?
This request has not been sent back to you, so it cannot be changed	It was already resubmitted (perhaps in another tab), or an administrator cancelled it. Open the request to see where it is.
This step has already been completed	It was decided already (by you in another tab, or by a delegate). Refresh to see the result.
This request is rejected / cancelled and can no longer be changed	The request closed while you had it open. No action is needed.
Request not found	The request is not yours, or the number is wrong. Submitters can open only their own requests.
The PDF has not been generated yet	Wait a minute and try again.
Too many attempts. Please wait a minute.	Sign-in attempts are limited. Wait one minute.
A new version of FileBank WorkFlow is available	The system was updated while your page was open. Choose Reload (anything typed on this page is lost), or carry on: the next page you open loads the new version by itself.

Good practice

- Never share your password key or codes, and do not forward approval links. Every decision is recorded against your account.
- Write reasons, send-back messages and comments carefully: they become part of the permanent PDF record.
- Prefer **Send back for changes** over rejecting when a request can be fixed: the submitter does not have to start again.
- Decide promptly. Waiting requests show to administrators as overdue.